

# US Patent & Trademark Office

## Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250279462

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

Inventor(s)

ZHANG; Xiaowei et al.

### WINDING DEVICE AND WINDING METHOD

#### Abstract

A winding device and a winding method. The winding device includes a winding mechanism configured to wind an electrode plate to form an electrode assembly. The winding mechanism includes: a winding needle assembly, including an inner winding needle and an outer winding needle surrounding the inner winding needle; and a piezoelectric assembly, disposed between the outer winding needle and the inner winding needle and configured to control the outer winding needle to move relative to the inner winding needle to adjust a circumference of the outer winding needle.

**Inventors:** ZHANG; Xiaowei (Ningde, CN), WEI; Hui (Ningde, CN), ZHANG; Zhan (Ningde, CN), WANG; Zhiwen (Ningde, CN), WEN; Yuqian (Ningde, CN), TANG; Minghao (Ningde, CN), ZHANG; Shengwu (Ningde, CN)

**Applicant:** CONTEMPORARY AMPEREX TECHNOLOGY CO., LIMITED (Ningde, CN)

**Family ID:** 91803349

**Appl. No.:** 19/212338

**Filed:** May 19, 2025

#### Related U.S. Application Data

parent WO continuation PCT/CN2023/070146 20230103 PENDING child US 19212338

#### Publication Classification

**Int. Cl.:** H01M10/04 (20060101); B65H18/10 (20060101); B65H39/16 (20060101)

**U.S. Cl.:**

**CPC** H01M10/0409 (20130101); B65H18/10 (20130101); B65H39/16 (20130101); H01M10/0431 (20130101); B65H2404/4211 (20130101); B65H2405/50 (20130101);

## Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION [0001] This application is a continuation of International Application No. PCT/CN2023/070146, filed on Jan. 3, 2023, the entire content of which is incorporated herein by reference.

### TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] This application relates to the field of battery technologies, and in particular, to a winding device and a winding method.

### BACKGROUND

[0003] In the production process of batteries, a winding needle is typically used to wind positive and negative electrode plates to form an electrode assembly. A circumference of the winding needle is closely related to an alignment of tabs of the electrode plates and the dimensions of the electrode assembly, directly affecting the quality of the electrode assembly. Therefore, how to effectively adjust the circumference of the winding needle has become a problem to be solved.

### SUMMARY

[0004] This application provides a winding device and a winding method capable of effectively adjusting a circumference of a winding needle.

[0005] According to a first aspect, a winding device is provided. The winding device includes a winding mechanism configured to wind an electrode plate to form an electrode assembly. The winding mechanism includes: a winding needle assembly, including an inner winding needle and an outer winding needle surrounding the inner winding needle; and a piezoelectric assembly, disposed between the outer winding needle and the inner winding needle and configured to control the outer winding needle to move relative to the inner winding needle to adjust a circumference of the outer winding needle.

[0006] In an embodiment of this application, a piezoelectric assembly is disposed between the inner winding needle and the outer winding needle. A driving voltage of the piezoelectric assembly is adjusted according to a misalignment amount of a tab, so that the piezoelectric assembly can drive the outer winding needle to move relative to the inner winding needle, thereby changing the circumference of the outer winding needle, reducing a misalignment amount of the tab in the subsequent winding process, ensuring the quality of the electrode assembly.

[0007] In an embodiment, the outer winding needle includes a first sub-outer needle and a second sub-outer needle disposed opposite each other. The inner winding needle includes a first sub-inner needle and a second sub-inner needle disposed opposite each other. The first sub-outer needle surrounds the first sub-inner needle, and the second sub-outer needle surrounds the second sub-inner needle. The piezoelectric assembly is configured to control the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle to move in opposite directions to adjust a distance between the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle.

[0008] In this embodiment, the outer winding needle includes a first sub-outer needle and a second sub-outer needle disposed opposite each other. By controlling the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle to move in opposite directions, the distance between the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle can be increased or decreased, thereby changing the circumference of the outer winding needle. The operation is simple and easy to implement.

[0009] In an embodiment, a movement distance  $L$  of each of the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle and an adjustment amount  $\Delta C$  of the circumference of the outer winding needle meet:  $\Delta C = K * L$ , where  $K$  is a predetermined coefficient. For example, when the first sub-

outer needle and the second sub-outer needle are symmetrical structures,  $K=4$ .

[0010] Since the movement distance  $L$  of each of the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle is linearly related to the adjustment amount  $\Delta C$  of the circumference of the outer winding needle, after determining the adjustment amount  $\Delta C$  of the required adjustment circumference according to the misalignment amount of the tab, the distance  $L$  that the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle require to move can be obtained. Therefore, a matching driving voltage is utilized to control the piezoelectric assembly to drive the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle to move by the distance  $L$ .

[0011] In an embodiment, a correction amount  $C_m$  of a tab in an  $M$ -th layer of the electrode assembly meets:  $C_m = M * \Delta C$ . The correction amount includes a misalignment correction amount. When correcting a misalignment of the tab, the number of winding layers where the tab is located needs to be considered to obtain an accurate correction amount.

[0012] In an embodiment, the first sub-outer needle is fixed to a piezoelectric assembly between the first sub-outer needle and the first sub-inner needle, and the second sub-outer needle is fixed to a piezoelectric assembly between the second sub-outer needle and the second sub-inner needle. In this way, a fixed connection is formed between the first sub-outer needle and the corresponding piezoelectric assembly and between the second sub-outer needle and the corresponding piezoelectric assembly, allowing the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle to move under the drive of the corresponding piezoelectric assemblies.

[0013] In an embodiment, the piezoelectric assembly between the first sub-outer needle and the first sub-inner needle is fixed to the first sub-inner needle, and the piezoelectric assembly between the second sub-outer needle and the second sub-inner needle is fixed to the second sub-inner needle. The piezoelectric assembly can be fixed to the inner winding needle by screws, thereby ensuring the structural reliability of the piezoelectric assembly.

[0014] In an embodiment, an elastic assembly is connected between the first sub-outer needle and the first sub-inner needle and between the second sub-outer needle and the second sub-inner needle, respectively. Before the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle are subjected to a force applied by the piezoelectric assembly, the elastic assembly can provide a preload force to the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle to enhance the connection reliability with the piezoelectric assembly. This prevents gaps or relative slippage between the first sub-outer needle and the piezoelectric assembly and between the second sub-outer needle and the piezoelectric assembly after the piezoelectric assembly applies a force to the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle, thereby ensuring winding accuracy.

[0015] In an embodiment, the elastic assembly includes a screw and a spring sleeved on the screw. One end of the screw close to the head is provided with a gasket, and one end of the screw close to a tail is provided with a bushing. The spring is used to provide a preload force to the outer winding needle, which is easy to implement and low in cost.

[0016] In an embodiment, a flat plate is disposed between the first sub-outer needle and the first sub-inner needle and between the second sub-outer needle and the second sub-inner needle. The flat plate is configured to increase an acting area of the piezoelectric assembly on the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle. This ensures that the force applied to the outer winding needle is more uniform, thereby ensuring the stability of the outer winding needle during movement.

[0017] In an embodiment, the winding mechanism further includes: an inner clamping needle, including a first portion surrounded by the first sub-inner needle and a second portion surrounded by the second sub-inner needle. A gap is formed between the first portion and the second portion, and the inner clamping needle is configured to fix a separator passing through the gap. Using the inner clamping needle to fix a starting end of the separator facilitates the winding of the separator.

[0018] In an embodiment, multiple winding mechanisms are provided. The multiple winding mechanisms are coaxially arranged and spaced apart and configured to wind multiple electrode

plates simultaneously. The multiple winding mechanisms share the same inner winding needle and inner clamping needle. The winding device of this embodiment of this application can simultaneously wind multiple electrode plates, greatly improving production efficiency.

[0019] In an embodiment, multiple piezoelectric assemblies in the multiple winding mechanisms are respectively configured to independently adjust the circumferences of multiple outer winding needles in the multiple winding mechanisms. Since the piezoelectric assemblies in the multiple winding mechanisms can be independently controlled, the circumferences of the corresponding outer winding needles can be independently adjusted for respective tab misalignment conditions of the multiple electrode plates, thereby ensuring respective winding accuracy.

[0020] In an embodiment, the winding device further includes: an electric slip ring, configured to provide a lead for connecting the piezoelectric assembly to an external circuit. The lead includes an input line and an output line. The input line is configured to connect to the external circuit, and the output line is configured to connect to a wire of the piezoelectric assembly. The external circuit inputs a driving voltage to the piezoelectric assembly through the lead and the wire. In this way, the transmission of electrical signals between a fixed structure and a rotating structure is achieved by using the electric slip ring, providing the driving voltage to the piezoelectric assembly.

[0021] In an embodiment, the winding mechanism further includes: a displacement monitoring device, configured to monitor a displacement of the outer winding needle to perform closed-loop control of the piezoelectric assembly. Using the displacement monitoring device to detect an actual displacement of the outer winding needle, and based on this, performing closed-loop control of the piezoelectric assembly allows the displacement of the outer winding needle to quickly and accurately reach a target value, ensuring adjustment accuracy.

[0022] In an embodiment, the displacement monitoring device includes a displacement sensing piece and a displacement sensor. The displacement sensing piece is fixed to the outer winding needle. The displacement sensor is configured to emit a signal to irradiate the displacement sensing piece and determine a displacement of the outer winding needle according to strength of a signal returned. A non-contact detection of the displacement of the outer winding needle can be achieved by using the displacement sensing piece and the displacement sensor, with high detection accuracy.

[0023] In an embodiment, the winding device further includes: a misalignment detection device, configured to detect an actual angle value of a tab of an electrode plate to be wound. A difference between the actual angle value and a standard angle value corresponding to the tab is used to determine the misalignment amount of the tab, enabling the winding mechanism to adjust the circumference of the outer winding needle according to the misalignment amount. The actual angle value is an angle through which the winding mechanism rotates when the tab reaches the winding mechanism. Using the misalignment detection device to detect the angle through which the winding mechanism rotates from a starting position when the tab reaches the winding mechanism can effectively determine a misalignment direction and a misalignment amount of the tab. The circumference of the outer winding needle is then adjusted according to the misalignment amount to reduce the misalignment amount of the tab in the subsequent winding process, ensuring the quality of the electrode assembly.

[0024] In an embodiment, the winding device further includes: a thickness detection device, configured to detect a thickness of the electrode plate to be wound and the separator, enabling the winding mechanism to adjust the circumference of the outer winding needle according to the thickness. By detecting the thickness of the electrode plate and the separator, the misalignment direction and the misalignment amount of the tab can be predicted, and the circumference of the outer winding needle can be adjusted according to the misalignment amount, thereby preventing tab misalignment caused by thickness fluctuations of the electrode plate and the separator before and after material replacement, ensuring the quality of the electrode assembly.

[0025] According to a second aspect, a winding method is provided. The winding method is configured to control a winding mechanism in the winding device described in the first aspect or

any one of embodiments in the first aspect to wind an electrode plate to form an electrode assembly. The winding method includes: obtaining a detection result of the electrode plate; determining adjustment information of an outer winding needle in the winding mechanism according to the detection result, the adjustment information including an adjustment amount and/or adjustment direction of a circumference of the outer winding needle; and determining a driving voltage of a piezoelectric assembly in the winding mechanism according to the adjustment information.

[0026] In this embodiment, since the piezoelectric assembly is used to drive the outer winding needle to move relative to an inner winding needle, thereby changing the circumference of the outer winding needle, after determining the adjustment information of the outer winding needle according to the detection result of the electrode plate, the magnitude of the driving voltage to be input to the piezoelectric assembly can be obtained, resulting in the piezoelectric assembly generating strain, driving the outer winding needle to move to change its circumference. In this way, a misalignment amount of the tab can be reduced in the subsequent winding process, ensuring the quality of the electrode assembly.

[0027] In an embodiment, a correction amount for a tab in an M-th layer of the electrode assembly is:  $C_m = M \cdot \Delta C$ , where  $\Delta C$  is the adjustment amount of the circumference of the outer winding needle, and  $C_m$  is the correction amount. When correcting the misalignment of the tab, the number of winding layers where the tab is located needs to be considered to obtain an accurate correction amount.

[0028] In an embodiment, the winding method further includes: obtaining a displacement of the outer winding needle; and adjusting the driving voltage according to a difference between the displacement and a target value until the displacement of the outer winding needle equals the target value. Detecting the actual displacement of the outer winding needle, and based on this, performing closed-loop control of the piezoelectric assembly allows the displacement of the outer winding needle to quickly and accurately reach the target value, ensuring adjustment accuracy.

[0029] In an embodiment, the detection result includes: a misalignment amount of the tab; and/or a thickness of the electrode plate and a separator. A misalignment direction and a misalignment amount of the tab can be directly detected, and the circumference of the outer winding needle can be adjusted according to the detection result to reduce the misalignment amount of the tab in the subsequent winding process. Alternatively, by detecting the thickness of the electrode plate and the separator, the misalignment direction and the misalignment amount of the tab can be predicted, and the circumference of the outer winding needle can be adjusted according to the misalignment amount, thereby preventing tab misalignment caused by thickness fluctuations of the electrode plate and the separator before and after material replacement.

---

## Description

### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

[0030] To describe the technical solutions in the embodiments of this application more clearly, the following briefly describes the accompanying drawings required for describing the embodiments of this application. Apparently, the accompanying drawings in the following descriptions show merely some embodiments of this application, and persons of ordinary skill in the art may still derive other drawings from the accompanying drawings without creative efforts.

[0031] FIG. 1 is a three-dimensional schematic diagram of a winding device according to an embodiment of this application.

[0032] FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of a circumference change of an outer winding needle.

[0033] FIG. 3 is a top view schematic diagram of a winding device according to an embodiment of this application.

[0034] FIG. 4 is a schematic cross-sectional view of a winding device according to an embodiment of this application.

[0035] FIG. 5 is a schematic cross-sectional view of a winding device according to an embodiment of this application.

[0036] FIG. 6 is a three-dimensional schematic diagram of a winding device according to an embodiment of this application.

[0037] FIG. 7 is a front view schematic diagram of a winding device according to an embodiment of this application.

[0038] FIG. 8 is a schematic diagram of a misalignment detection device.

[0039] FIG. 9 is a schematic diagram of a thickness detection device.

[0040] FIG. 10 is a schematic flowchart of a winding method according to an embodiment of this application.

[0041] FIG. 11 is a flowchart of a possible specific implementation of the winding method shown in FIG. 10.

[0042] Reference signs: **100**—winding device; **1**—winding mechanism; **10**—winding needle assembly; **20**—piezoelectric assembly; **11**—inner winding needle; **12**—outer winding needle; **12-1**—first sub-outer needle; **12-2**—second sub-outer needle; **11-1**—first sub-inner needle; **11-2**—second sub-inner needle; **40**—elastic assembly; **41**—screw; **42**—spring; **43**—gasket; **44**—bushing; **50**—flat plate; **60**—inner clamping needle; **61**—first portion of inner clamping needle; **62**—second portion of inner clamping needle; **71**—winding needle base; **72**—support base; **80**—electric slip ring; **81**—input line of electric slip ring; **82**—output line of electric slip ring; **83-1**—wire of piezoelectric assembly; **83-2**—wire of piezoelectric assembly; **90**—displacement monitoring device; **91**—displacement sensing piece; **92**—displacement sensor; **93**—mounting plate of displacement sensor; **2**—misalignment detection device; **3**—thickness detection device; **1001**—electrode plate; **1002**—electrode plate; **1003**—separator; **1004**—separator.

#### DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

[0043] The following further describes implementations of this application in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings and embodiments. The detailed description and the accompanying drawings of the following embodiments are intended to illustrate the principle of this application, rather than to limit the scope of this application, meaning this application is not limited to the embodiments described herein.

[0044] In the description of this application, it should be noted that unless otherwise stated, “multiple” means two or more; and the terms “upper”, “lower”, “left”, “right”, “inside”, “outside”, and the like are merely for ease and brevity of description of this application rather than indicating or implying that the apparatuses or elements mentioned must have specific orientations or be constructed and manipulated according to specific orientations, and therefore shall not be construed as any limitations on this application. In addition, the terms “first”, “second”, “third”, and the like are merely intended for a purpose of description, and shall not be understood as any indication or implication of relative importance. “Perpendicular” is not strictly perpendicular, but within the allowable range of error. “Parallel” is not strictly parallel, but within the allowable range of error.

[0045] The words of orientation appearing in the following description all are directions shown in the drawings, and do not limit the specific structure of this disclosure. In the description of this application, it should also be noted that unless otherwise specified and defined explicitly, the terms “mounting”, “connection”, and “join” should be understood in their general senses. For example, they may refer to a fixed connection, a detachable connection, or an integral connection, and may refer to a direct connection or an indirect connection via an intermediate medium. Persons of ordinary skill in the art can understand the specific meanings of foregoing terms in this disclosure as appropriate to specific situations.

[0046] A battery in the embodiments of this application refers to a single physical module including one or more battery cells for providing a higher voltage and capacity. For example, the battery

mentioned in this application may include a battery module, a battery pack, or the like. The battery typically includes a box for packaging one or more battery cells. The box can prevent liquids or other foreign matter from affecting the charging or discharging of the battery cells.

[0047] The battery cell may include an electrode assembly and an electrolyte. The electrode assembly, also referred to as a cell, includes a positive electrode plate, a negative electrode plate, and a separator. The battery cell works mainly depending on migration of metal ions between the positive electrode plate and the negative electrode plate. The positive electrode plate includes a positive electrode current collector and a positive electrode active substance layer. The positive electrode active substance layer is applied to a surface of the positive electrode current collector, and a current collector uncoated with the positive electrode active substance layer protrudes from the current collector coated with the positive electrode active substance layer and serves as a positive electrode tab. Taking a lithium-ion battery as an example, the positive electrode current collector may be made of aluminum, and the positive electrode active material may be lithium cobaltate, lithium iron phosphate, ternary lithium, lithium manganate, or the like. The negative electrode plate includes a negative electrode current collector and a negative electrode active substance layer. The negative electrode active substance layer is applied to a surface of the negative electrode current collector, and a current collector uncoated with the negative electrode active substance layer protrudes from the current collector coated with the negative electrode active substance layer and serves as a negative electrode tab. The negative electrode current collector may be made of copper, and the negative electrode active substance may be graphite, carbon, silicon, or the like. To allow a large current to pass through without any fusing, multiple positive electrode tabs are provided and stacked together, and multiple negative electrode tabs are provided and stacked together. The following description takes the separator as an example, where the separator may be made of polypropylene (polypropylene, PP), polyethylene (polyethylene, PE), or the like. In addition, the electrode assembly may be a wound structure or a stacked structure. However, the embodiments of this application are not limited thereto.

[0048] As the thickness of the electrode assembly increases and the number of winding layers increases, factors such as variations in the thickness of the electrode plate or separator, fluctuations in the tension of the electrode plate during the winding process, and differences in the die-cutting dimensions of the tabs can easily cause tab misalignment issues during the winding process of the electrode plate, thereby affecting the quality of the electrode assembly. Therefore, a circumference of the winding needle needs to be effectively adjusted to reduce the misalignment amount of the tabs.

[0049] To this end, an embodiment of this application provides a winding device aimed at solving the problem of how to effectively adjust the circumference of the winding needle. The circumference of the winding needle is adjusted by controlling the radial movement of the winding needle through a piezoelectric assembly, thereby reducing the misalignment amount of the tabs.

[0050] FIG. 1 and FIG. 3 are schematic diagrams of a winding device according to an embodiment of this application. FIG. 1 is a three-dimensional schematic diagram of the winding device, and FIG. 3 is a top view schematic diagram of the winding device. As shown in FIG. 1 and FIG. 3, the winding device **100** includes a winding mechanism **1**. The winding mechanism **1** is configured to wind an electrode plate to form an electrode assembly. The winding mechanism **1** includes a winding needle assembly **10** and a piezoelectric assembly **20**. The winding needle assembly **10** includes an inner winding needle **11** and an outer winding needle **12**, where the outer winding needle **12** surrounds the inner winding needle **11**. The piezoelectric assembly **20** is disposed between the outer winding needle **12** and the inner winding needle **11** and is configured to control the outer winding needle **12** to move relative to the inner winding needle **11**, that is, to control a distance between the outer winding needle **12** and the inner winding needle **11** to adjust a circumference of the outer winding needle **12**.

[0051] The shapes of the inner winding needle **11** and the outer winding needle **12** in the winding

needle assembly **10** include, but are not limited to, circular, elliptical, polygonal with an edge number greater than three, polygonal with a smooth end angle transition, flat shapes, and the like. The materials of the inner winding needle **11** and the outer winding needle **12** include, but are not limited to, carbon steel, carbon structural steel, high-quality structural steel, carbon tool steel, free-cutting structural steel, alloy steel, ordinary low-alloy steel, alloy steel for engineering structures, alloy steel for mechanical structures, alloy structural steel, alloy tool steel, high-speed tool steel, and the like.

[0052] The piezoelectric assembly **20** may include, for example, several piezoelectric crystals, and may also include a corresponding mechanical amplifier such as a deformation amplifier in the form of a hinge (not shown in the figure), to amplify an elongation and contraction of the piezoelectric crystals. When a driving voltage is input to the piezoelectric crystals, assuming a generated electric field strength is  $E$ , the piezoelectric crystals produce a strain  $x$ , where  $x=dt \cdot E$ ,  $dt$  being an inverse piezoelectric coefficient. The piezoelectric crystals expand or contract along the direction of the electric field. The direction of the electric field is set as a radial direction of the winding needle assembly **10**, a greater electric field strength  $E$  received by the piezoelectric crystals indicates a greater strain  $x$  and a greater movement distance of the outer winding needle. Based on this, a suitable driving voltage can be output according to the detected misalignment direction and misalignment amount of the tab, allowing the piezoelectric assembly **20** to drive the outer winding needle to move radially to change the circumference of the outer winding needle **12**, thereby reducing the misalignment amount of the tab. In this embodiment of this application, the piezoelectric assembly **20** is configured to control the movement of the outer winding needle **12**, allowing the adjustment accuracy of the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** by the winding mechanism **1** to reach the micron level.

[0053] It can be seen that by disposing the piezoelectric assembly **20** between the inner winding needle **11** and the outer winding needle **12** and adjusting a driving voltage of the piezoelectric assembly **20** according to the misalignment amount of the tab, so that the piezoelectric assembly **20** can drive the outer winding needle **12** to move relative to the inner winding needle **11**, thereby changing the circumference of the outer winding needle **12**, reducing the misalignment amount of the tab in the subsequent winding process, ensuring the quality of the electrode assembly. Since the movement of the outer winding needle **12** utilizes the piezoelectric assembly **20** rather than a complex mechanical structure, the risk of particles caused by mechanical friction falling into the electrode assembly and piercing the separator is prevented, ensuring the safety of the electrode assembly.

[0054] The number of winding mechanisms **1** in the winding device of the embodiment of this application can be set to multiple. The multiple winding mechanisms **1** are configured to wind multiple electrode plates simultaneously to form multiple electrode assemblies, greatly improving production efficiency and facilitating subsequent maintenance and replacement for a certain winding mechanism **1**. The multiple winding mechanisms **1** are coaxially arranged and spaced apart to ensure rotational consistency of the multiple winding mechanisms **1** during winding.

[0055] The multiple winding mechanisms **1** can share the same inner winding needle **11**, meaning that multiple outer winding needles **12** are disposed on an outer side of the inner winding needle **11**, and the inner winding needle **11** has the capability of winding multiple electrode plates simultaneously.

[0056] The circumferences of the outer winding needles **12** in the multiple winding mechanisms **1** can be the same or different. That is, the piezoelectric assemblies **20** in the multiple winding mechanisms **1** can be independently controlled. The multiple piezoelectric assemblies **20** in the multiple winding mechanisms **1** are respectively configured to independently adjust the circumferences of the multiple outer winding needles **12** in the multiple winding mechanisms **1**. Therefore, the circumferences of the corresponding outer winding needles **12** can be adjusted according to the respective tab misalignment conditions of the multiple electrode plates. In



addition, core components of the winding mechanism **1** are small in size, and the movements of the multiple winding mechanisms **1** during their respective winding processes are minimal, preventing mutual interference between the multiple winding mechanisms **1** and ensuring their respective winding accuracy. As shown in FIG. **1** and FIG. **3**, two winding mechanisms **1** are used as an example. The two winding mechanisms **1** are coaxially arranged and spaced apart, and capable of independently winding two sets of electrode plates to form two electrode assemblies.

[0057] In an embodiment, as shown in FIG. **1**, the outer winding needle **12** includes a first sub-outer needle **12-1** and a second sub-outer needle **12-2** disposed opposite each other. The inner winding needle **11** includes a first sub-inner needle **11-1** and a second sub-inner needle **11-2** disposed opposite each other. The first sub-outer needle **12-1** surrounds the first sub-inner needle **11-1**, and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** surrounds the second sub-inner needle **11-2**. The first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the first sub-inner needle **11-1** can be referred to as one set of sub-needles, and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** and the second sub-inner needle **11-2** can be referred to as another set of sub-needles. Each set of sub-needles is provided with a piezoelectric assembly **20**, and the piezoelectric assemblies **20** in each set of sub-needles can be independently controlled. The piezoelectric assembly **20** is configured to control the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** to move in opposite directions to adjust a distance between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2**, for example, to increase or decrease the distance between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2**.

[0058] For example, a piezoelectric assembly **20** between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the first sub-inner needle **11-1** controls the first sub-outer needle **12-1** to move away from an axis relative to the first sub-inner needle **11-1**, and a piezoelectric assembly **20** between the second sub-outer needle **12-2** and the second sub-inner needle **11-2** controls the second sub-outer needle **12-2** to move away from the axis relative to the second sub-inner needle **11-2**. In this case, the distance between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** increases, and the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** increases. Conversely, the piezoelectric assembly **20** between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the first sub-inner needle **11-1** controls the first sub-outer needle **12-1** to move toward the axis relative to the first sub-inner needle **11-1**, and the piezoelectric assembly **20** between the second sub-outer needle **12-2** and the second sub-inner needle **11-2** controls the second sub-outer needle **12-2** to move toward the axis relative to the second sub-inner needle **11-2**. In this case, the distance between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** decreases, and the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** decreases.

[0059] It can be seen that by controlling the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** to move in opposite directions, the distance between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** can be increased or decreased, thereby changing the circumference of the outer winding needle **12**. The operation is simple and easy to implement.

[0060] For the stable operation of the winding mechanism **1**, the two sets of sub-needles can adopt a symmetrical structure. Several piezoelectric crystals are symmetrically installed between the sub-inner needle and the sub-outer needle in each set, and the piezoelectric crystals in the two sets of sub-needles are symmetrically arranged. For example, one piezoelectric crystal or two piezoelectric crystals are installed between the sub-inner needle and the sub-outer needle in each set.

[0061] A movement distance  $L$  of each of the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** and an adjustment amount  $\Delta C$  of the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** can meet:  $\Delta C = K * L$ , where  $K$  is a predetermined coefficient. When the outer winding needle **12** is a circular, elliptical, or diamond-shaped winding needle with a symmetrical structure,  $K=4$ , that is,  $\Delta C = 4 * L$ .

[0062] For example, as shown in FIG. **2**, the outer winding needle **12** is circular with a symmetrical structure. The first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** are symmetrically arranged semicircles, and the positions of the first sub-inner needle **11-1** and the second sub-inner

needle **11-2** are fixed. Assuming that (a) in FIG. 2 is the initial state and (b) is the adjusted state, and the piezoelectric assembly **20** drives the first sub-outer needle **12-1** to move a distance  $L$  relative to the first sub-inner needle **11-1**, and the piezoelectric assembly **20** drives the second sub-outer needle **12-2** to move a distance  $L$  relative to the second sub-inner needle **11-2**, the adjustment amount  $\Delta C$  of the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** is equivalent to an increase of  $4*L$ . [0063] Since the movement distance  $L$  of each of the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** is linearly related to the adjustment amount  $\Delta C$  of the circumference of the outer winding needle **12**, after determining the direction and adjustment amount  $\Delta C$  of the circumference adjustment according to the misalignment direction and the misalignment amount of the tab, the distance  $L$  that the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** require to move can be obtained. Then, the suitable driving voltage is output according to the piezoelectric characteristics of the piezoelectric crystal, and the piezoelectric assembly **20** drives the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** to move, causing each of the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** to move the distance  $L$ .

[0064] The misalignment amount of the tab is typically accumulated layer by layer. When correcting a misalignment of the tab, the number of winding layers where the tab is located needs to be considered to obtain an accurate correction amount. In an embodiment, a correction amount  $C_m$  of the tab in an  $M$ -th layer meets:  $C_m = M * \Delta C$ , where  $M$  ranges from 1 to  $N$ . For example, assuming the number of layers of the electrode assembly is  $N$ , during the winding process, when the misalignment amount of the tab in the  $M$ -th layer exceeds a predetermined threshold,  $1 \leq M \leq N$ , the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** needs to be adjusted. In practice, the misalignment amount of the tab in the  $M$ -th layer relative to the tab in the first layer is the cumulative misalignment amount of the tabs in the layers before the  $M$ -th layer, where the tab in each layer produces a certain misalignment relative to the tab in the previous layer. Therefore, the correction amount  $C_m$  can be determined according to the misalignment amount of the tab in the  $M$ -th layer relative to the tab in the first layer, where the correction amount  $C_m$  is typically equal to this misalignment amount. The adjustment amount  $\Delta C$  is calculated according to  $C_m = M * \Delta C$ , and the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** is adjusted according to  $\Delta C$ . Thus, in the subsequent winding process, the positions of the tabs in the layers after the  $M$ -th layer are the same, and the tabs in each layer are no longer misaligned relative to the tab in the previous layer.

[0065] In an embodiment, as shown in FIG. 4, the first sub-outer needle **12-1** is fixed to the piezoelectric assembly **20** between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the first sub-inner needle **11-1**, and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** is fixed to the piezoelectric assembly **20** between the second sub-outer needle **12-2** and the second sub-inner needle **11-2**. In this way, a fixed connection is formed between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the corresponding piezoelectric assembly **20** and between the second sub-outer needle **12-2** and the corresponding piezoelectric assembly **20**, allowing the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** to move under the drive of the respective piezoelectric assemblies **20**. For example, as shown in FIG. 4, the first sub-outer needle **12-1** can be fixed to the corresponding piezoelectric assembly **20** using a fastener such as a screw **31**, and/or the second sub-outer needle **12-2** can be fixed to the corresponding piezoelectric assembly **20** using a fastener such as a screw **31**.

[0066] In an embodiment, the piezoelectric assembly **20** between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the first sub-inner needle **11-1** can be fixed to the first sub-inner needle **11-1** by screws, and the piezoelectric assembly **20** between the second sub-outer needle **12-2** and the second sub-inner needle **11-2** can be fixed to the second sub-inner needle **11-2** by screws. In this way, the piezoelectric assembly **20** is fixed to the inner winding needle **11** by screws, ensuring the structural reliability of the piezoelectric assembly **20**. For example, the corresponding piezoelectric assemblies **20** can be fixed to the first sub-inner needle **11-1** and the second sub-inner needle **11-2**, respectively, using fasteners such as screws.

[0067] In an embodiment, as shown in FIG. 5, an elastic assembly **40** is connected between the first

sub-outer needle **12-1** and the first sub-inner needle **11-1** and between the second sub-outer needle **12-2** and the second sub-inner needle **11-2**, respectively. Before the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** are subjected to a force applied by the piezoelectric assembly **20**, the elastic assembly **40** can provide a preload force to the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** to enhance the connection reliability with the piezoelectric assembly **20**. This prevents gaps or relative slippage between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the piezoelectric assembly **20** and between the second sub-outer needle **12-2** and the piezoelectric assembly **20** after the piezoelectric assembly **20** applies a force to the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2**, thereby ensuring winding accuracy.

[0068] The elastic assembly **40** can be implemented in various ways. For example, a spring can be used to provide a preload force to the outer winding needle **12**, which is easy to implement and low in cost. As shown in FIG. 5, the elastic assembly **40** includes a screw **41** and a spring **42** sleeved on the screw **41**. One end of the screw **41** close to a head is provided with a gasket **43**, such as a plastic gasket **43**, and one end of the screw **41** close to a tail is provided with a bushing **44**. During assembly, the upper gasket **43** and spring **42** are sequentially sleeved onto the screw **41**, then the lower bushing **44** is sleeved onto the screw **41**, and finally, the screw **41** is tightened and fixed to the first sub-inner needle **11-1** and the second sub-inner needle **11-2**.

[0069] In an embodiment, a flat plate **50**, also referred to as an active plate **50**, is disposed between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the first sub-inner needle **11-1** and between the second sub-outer needle **12-2** and the second sub-inner needle **11-2**. The flat plate **50** is configured to increase an acting area of the piezoelectric assembly **20** on the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2**.

[0070] For example, as shown in FIG. 5, the flat plate **50** is disposed between the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the corresponding piezoelectric assembly **20** and between the second sub-outer needle **12-2** and the corresponding piezoelectric assembly **20**. The flat plate **50** is used to transmit the force applied by the piezoelectric assembly **20** to the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2**, increasing a pushing area of the piezoelectric assembly **20** on the outer winding needle **12**, allowing the force applied to the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** to be more uniform, ensuring the stability of the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** during movement.

[0071] In an embodiment, as shown in FIG. 5, the winding mechanism **1** further includes an inner clamping needle **60**. Multiple winding mechanisms **1** can share the same inner clamping needle **60**. The inner clamping needle **60** includes a first portion **61** surrounded by the first sub-inner needle **11-1** and a second portion **62** surrounded by the second sub-inner needle **11-2**. A gap is formed between the first portion **61** and the second portion **62**, and the inner clamping needle **60** is configured to fix a separator passing through the gap, facilitating the winding of the separator.

[0072] Typically, before winding the electrode plate and the separator, the separator is passed through the gap between the first portion **61** and the second portion **62** of the inner clamping needle **60**. The first portion **61** and the second portion **62** apply a clamping force to the separator to fix a starting end of the separator, facilitating the winding of the separator. After winding the separator for several turns, the electrode plate is fed in and wound together with the electrode plate using friction.

[0073] As shown in FIG. 1 to FIG. 6, the winding device **100** further includes a winding needle base **71** and a support base **72**. Two ends of the inner winding needle **11** are respectively disposed on the winding needle base **71** and the support base **72**. It can be understood that the inner clamping needle **60**, the inner winding needle **11**, and the outer winding needle **12** are coaxially arranged. However, only the inner winding needle **11** does not move radially. Both the inner clamping needle **60** and the outer winding needle **12** can move radially relative to the inner winding needle **11** to achieve the functions of clamping the separator and adjusting its circumference, respectively.

[0074] In an embodiment, as shown in FIG. 1 to FIG. 6, the winding device **100** further includes an electric slip ring **80**, configured to provide a lead for connecting the piezoelectric assembly **20** to an external circuit (not shown in the figure). The external circuit inputs a driving voltage to the piezoelectric assembly **20** through the lead. In this way, the electric slip ring **80** enables the transmission of electrical signals between a fixed structure and a rotating structure, providing the driving voltage to the piezoelectric assembly **20** and preventing the lead from twisting and pulling during the winding process.

[0075] For example, as shown in FIG. 4, the electric slip ring **80** is mounted to the winding needle base **71**, for example, by being fixed to a rotating assembly (not shown in the figure) using screws. The lead of the electric slip ring **80** includes an input line **81** and an output line **82**. The input line **81** is configured to connect to the external circuit, and the output line **82** is configured to connect to the piezoelectric assembly **20**. The piezoelectric assemblies **20** in the two sets of sub-needles of the winding mechanism **1** respectively lead out a wire **83-1** and a wire **83-2** connected to the output line **82** of the electric slip ring **80**. The external circuit inputs the driving voltage to the piezoelectric assembly **20** through the lead of the electric slip ring **80** and the wires of the piezoelectric assembly **20**.

[0076] In an embodiment, the winding mechanism **1** further includes a displacement monitoring device **90**, configured to monitor a displacement of the outer winding needle **12** to perform closed-loop control of the piezoelectric assembly **20**.

[0077] For example, as shown in FIG. 6 and FIG. 7, FIG. 6 is a three-dimensional schematic diagram of the winding device **100**, and FIG. 7 is a front view schematic diagram of the winding device **100**. The displacement monitoring device **90** includes a displacement sensing piece **91** and a displacement sensor **92**. The displacement sensing piece **91** is fixed to the outer winding needle **12**. The displacement sensor **92** is configured to emit a signal to irradiate the displacement sensing piece **91** and determine a displacement of the outer winding needle **12** according to strength of a signal returned. As shown in FIG. 6 and FIG. 7, the displacement sensor **92** of the winding mechanism **1** on a left side can be fixed to two sides of the winding needle base **71** using fasteners such as screws, and the displacement sensing piece **91** is fixed to the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** using fasteners such as screws. The displacement sensor **92** of the winding mechanism **1** on a right side can be fixed to a mounting plate **93** using fasteners such as screws, the mounting plate **93** is fixed to two sides of the support base **72**, and the displacement sensing piece **91** is fixed to the first sub-outer needle **12-1** and the second sub-outer needle **12-2** using fasteners such as screws. A non-contact detection of the displacement of the outer winding needle **12** can be achieved by using the displacement sensing piece **91** and the displacement sensor **92**, with high detection accuracy.

[0078] In this way, using the displacement monitoring device **90** to detect the displacement of the outer winding needle **12** and performing closed-loop control of the piezoelectric assembly **20** based on the detected displacement, that is, performing closed-loop adjustment on its driving voltage until the displacement of the outer winding needle **12** quickly and accurately reaches a target value, thereby further allowing the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** to be precisely increased or decreased.

[0079] In an embodiment, the winding device **100** further includes a misalignment detection device **2**, configured to detect an actual angle value of a tab of an electrode plate to be wound. A difference between the actual angle value and a standard angle value corresponding to the tab is used to determine the misalignment amount of the tab, enabling the winding mechanism to adjust the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** according to the misalignment amount. The actual angle value is an angle through which the winding mechanism **1** rotates when the tab reaches the winding mechanism **1**.

[0080] For example, as shown in FIG. 8, an electrode plate **1001**, an electrode plate **1002**, a separator **1003**, and a separator **1004** are wound together. Misalignment detection devices **2** are

respectively provided for the electrode plate **1001** and the electrode plate **1002**. The misalignment detection device **2** can be disposed upstream of the winding device **100** and is configured to sense the tabs that are about to be wound onto the winding mechanism **1** after the winding is started, so as to record the time and number of tabs entering the winding mechanism **1**. The misalignment detection device **2**, for example, may be a photoelectric sensor. When the tab blocks a light signal emitted by the photoelectric sensor, preventing the light signal from being transmitted, the photoelectric sensor detects the tab and sends a signal to a processing module. The processing module determines the misalignment amount according to the difference between the actual angle value of the tab and the corresponding standard angle value. The actual angle value of the tab, for example, is the angle through which the winding mechanism **1** rotates from a timing zero point to the time when the tab is detected to be about to be wound onto the winding mechanism **1**.

[0081] In this way, using the misalignment detection device **2** to detect the angle through which the winding mechanism **1** rotates from a starting position when the tab reaches the winding mechanism **1** can effectively determine the misalignment direction and the misalignment amount of the tab. The circumference of the outer winding needle **12** is then adjusted according to the misalignment amount to reduce the misalignment amount of the tab in the subsequent winding process, ensuring the quality of the electrode assembly.

[0082] In an embodiment, the winding device **100** further includes a thickness detection device **3**, configured to detect a thickness of the electrode plate to be wound and the separator, enabling the winding mechanism **1** to adjust the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** according to the thickness.

[0083] For example, as shown in FIG. **9**, thickness detection devices **3** are respectively provided for the electrode plate **1001**, the electrode plate **1002**, the separator **1003**, and the separator **1004**. Assuming the detected thickness values of the electrode plate **1001**, the electrode plate **1002**, the separator **1003**, and the separator **1004** are **T1**, **T2**, **T3**, and **T4**, respectively, a total thickness  $T=T1+T2+T3+T4$ . The winding mechanism **1** adjusts the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** according to the change in the thickness **T**.

[0084] In this way, by detecting the thickness of the electrode plate and the separator, the misalignment direction and the misalignment amount of the tab can be predicted, and the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** can be adjusted according to the misalignment amount, thereby preventing tab misalignment caused by thickness fluctuations of the electrode plate and the separator before and after material replacement, ensuring the quality of the electrode assembly.

[0085] This application also provides a winding method. The winding method **200** is configured to control the winding mechanism **1** in the winding device **100** described in any of the foregoing embodiments to wind the electrode plate to form an electrode assembly. The winding method **200**, for example, can be executed by a processing module, and the processing module, for example, can be connected to the input line **81** of the electric slip ring **80** or an external circuit. As shown in FIG. **10**, the winding method **200** includes some or all of the following steps.

[0086] Step **210**: Obtain a detection result of the electrode plate.

[0087] Step **220**: Determine adjustment information of the outer winding needle **12** in the winding mechanism **1** according to the detection result, where the adjustment information, for example, includes an adjustment amount and/or adjustment direction of the circumference of the outer winding needle **12**.

[0088] Step **230**: Determine a driving voltage of the piezoelectric assembly **20** in the winding mechanism **1** according to the adjustment information.

[0089] Since the piezoelectric assembly is used to drive the outer winding needle **12** to move relative to the inner winding needle **11**, thereby changing the circumference of the outer winding needle **12**, after determining the adjustment information of the outer winding needle **12** according to the detection result of the electrode plate, the magnitude of the driving voltage to be input to the

piezoelectric assembly **20** can be obtained, resulting in the piezoelectric assembly **20** generating strain or deformation, driving the outer winding needle **12** to move relative to the inner winding needle **11**, thereby changing the circumference of the outer winding needle **12**. In this way, the misalignment amount of the tab can be reduced in the subsequent winding process, ensuring the quality of the electrode assembly.

[0090] The detection result in step **210**, for example, may include: a misalignment amount of the tab; or the thickness of the electrode plate and the separator. In other words, the misalignment direction and the misalignment amount of the tab can be directly detected, and the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** can be adjusted based on the detection result to reduce the misalignment amount of the tab in the subsequent winding process. Alternatively, by detecting the thickness of the electrode plate and the separator, the misalignment direction and the misalignment amount of the tab can be predicted, and the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** can be adjusted according to the misalignment amount, thereby preventing tab misalignment caused by thickness fluctuations of the electrode plate and the separator before and after material replacement.

[0091] The misalignment amount of the tab is typically accumulated layer by layer. When correcting the misalignment of the tab, the number of winding layers where the tab is located needs to be considered to obtain an accurate correction amount. In an embodiment, a correction amount for a tab in an M-th layer of the electrode assembly is:  $C_m = M \cdot \Delta C$ , where  $\Delta C$  is the adjustment amount of the circumference of the outer winding needle, and  $C_m$  is the correction amount.

[0092] In an embodiment, the winding method **200** further includes: obtaining a displacement of the outer winding needle **12**; and adjusting the driving voltage of the piezoelectric assembly **20** according to a difference between the displacement and a target value until the displacement of the outer winding needle **12** equals the target value. Detecting the actual displacement of the outer winding needle **12**, and based on this, performing closed-loop control of the piezoelectric assembly **20** allows the displacement of the outer winding needle **12** to quickly and accurately reach the target value, ensuring adjustment accuracy.

[0093] For example, as shown in a flowchart of a possible specific implementation of the winding method **200** in FIG. **11**. FIG. **11** takes the control of two winding mechanisms **1** as an example. The two winding mechanisms operate in parallel and relatively independently, thereby allowing the circumferences of their respective outer winding needles **12** to be independently adjusted according to the detection results of the electrode plates being wound.

[0094] As shown in FIG. **11**, Step **1101**: Obtain a detection result of the tab and determine whether the tab is misaligned. If misalignment occurs, proceed to step **1102**. If no misalignment occurs, maintain the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** unchanged until the winding is completed.

[0095] Step **1102**: Start the winding device **100**.

[0096] Step **1103**: Calculate an adjustment amount of the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** according to the misalignment amount of the tab.

[0097] Step **1104**: Determine a magnitude of the driving voltage of the piezoelectric assembly **20** according to the adjustment amount of the circumference of the outer winding needle **12** to input the driving voltage to the piezoelectric assembly **20**.

[0098] Step **1005**: Detect whether the displacement of the outer winding needle **12** reaches a target value. If the displacement does not reach the target value, proceed to step **1106** until the displacement of the outer winding needle **12** reaches the target value; if the displacement reaches the target value, proceed to step **1107**.

[0099] Step **1106**: Correct the driving voltage of the piezoelectric assembly **20** according to a difference between the displacement of the outer winding needle **12** and the target value.

[0100] Step **1107**: Complete the winding and output a wound product to obtain the electrode assembly.

[0101] It should be understood that for specific details of the winding method **200**, reference can be

made to the description of the winding device **100** above. For brevity, details are not described here again.

[0102] The winding device **100** and the winding method **200** of the embodiments of this application can achieve simultaneous winding of multiple electrode plates to form multiple electrode assemblies and independently control the misalignment conditions of tabs on each electrode plate during the winding process, greatly improving winding efficiency and reducing production costs. In addition, since the piezoelectric assembly, rather than a complex mechanical structure, is utilized to control the radial movement of the winding needle, the structure of the winding device is simplified and its size is reduced, the cost is reduced, and the risk of particles caused by mechanical friction falling into the electrode assembly and piercing the separator is prevented, ensuring the safety of the electrode assembly.

[0103] It should be noted that in absence of conflicts, various embodiments described in this application and/or the technical features in the various embodiments may be combined with each other. The technical solutions obtained after combination should also fall within the protection scope of this application.

[0104] Persons of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that the units and algorithm steps of various examples described with reference to the embodiments disclosed in this specification can be implemented by using electronic hardware, or a combination of computer software and electronic hardware. Whether these functions are executed by hardware or software depends on the particular applications and design constraints of the technical solutions. Persons skilled in the art can use different methods to implement the described functions for each particular application, but such implementations should not be construed as going beyond the scope of this application.

[0105] It may be clearly understood by a person skilled in the art that, for the purpose of convenient and brief description, for a detailed working process of the foregoing system, apparatus, and unit, reference may be made to a corresponding process in the foregoing method embodiments, and details are not described herein again.

[0106] In the several embodiments provided in this application, it should be understood that the disclosed system, apparatus, and method may be implemented in other manners. For example, the described apparatus embodiments are merely illustrative. For example, the unit division is merely logical function division and other division manners may be used in actual implementation. For example, multiple units or components may be combined or integrated into another system, or some features may be ignored or not be performed. In addition, the displayed or discussed mutual couplings or direct couplings or communications connections may be implemented by using some interfaces. The indirect couplings or communications connections between apparatuses or units may be implemented in electrical, mechanical, or other forms.

[0107] The units described as separate parts may or may not be physically separate. Parts displayed as units may or may not be physical units, meaning they may be located in one position or distributed on multiple network units. Some or all of the units may be selected depending on actual requirements to achieve the objectives of the solutions of the embodiments.

## Claims

1. A winding device, comprising a winding mechanism configured to wind an electrode plate to form an electrode assembly, wherein the winding mechanism comprises: a winding needle assembly, comprising an inner winding needle and an outer winding needle surrounding the inner winding needle; and a piezoelectric assembly, disposed between the outer winding needle and the inner winding needle and configured to control the outer winding needle to move relative to the inner winding needle to adjust a circumference of the outer winding needle.
2. The winding device according to claim 1, wherein: the outer winding needle comprises a first sub-outer needle and a second sub-outer needle disposed opposite each other, and the inner winding

- needle comprises a first sub-inner needle and a second sub-inner needle disposed opposite each other, the first sub-outer needle surrounding the first sub-inner needle, and the second sub-outer needle surrounding the second sub-inner needle; and the piezoelectric assembly is configured to control the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle to move in opposite directions to adjust a distance between the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle.
- 3.** The winding device according to claim 2, wherein a movement distance  $L$  of each of the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle and an adjustment amount  $\Delta C$  of the circumference of the outer winding needle meet:  $\Delta C = K * L$ , wherein  $K$  is a predetermined coefficient.
- 4.** The winding device according to claim 3 wherein the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle are symmetrical structures, wherein  $K = 4$ .
- 5.** The winding device according to claim 2, wherein the first sub-outer needle is fixed to a piezoelectric assembly between the first sub-outer needle and the first sub-inner needle, and the second sub-outer needle is fixed to a piezoelectric assembly between the second sub-outer needle and the second sub-inner needle.
- 6.** The winding device according to claim 2, wherein the piezoelectric assembly between the first sub-outer needle and the first sub-inner needle is fixed to the first sub-inner needle, and the piezoelectric assembly between the second sub-outer needle and the second sub-inner needle is fixed to the second sub-inner needle.
- 7.** The winding device according to claim 2, wherein an elastic assembly is connected between the first sub-outer needle and the first sub-inner needle and between the second sub-outer needle and the second sub-inner needle, respectively.
- 8.** The winding device according to claim 7, wherein the elastic assembly comprises a screw and a spring sleeved on the screw, wherein one end of the screw close to a head is provided with a gasket, and one end of the screw close to a tail is provided with a bushing.
- 9.** The winding device according to claim 2, wherein a flat plate is disposed between the first sub-outer needle and the first sub-inner needle and between the second sub-outer needle and the second sub-inner needle, wherein the flat plate is configured to increase an acting area of the piezoelectric assembly on the first sub-outer needle and the second sub-outer needle.
- 10.** The winding device according to claim 2, wherein the winding mechanism further comprises: an inner clamping needle, comprising a first portion surrounded by the first sub-inner needle and a second portion surrounded by the second sub-inner needle, wherein a gap is formed between the first portion and the second portion, and the inner clamping needle is configured to fix a separator passing through the gap.
- 11.** The winding device according to claim 1, wherein the winding mechanism is one of multiple winding mechanisms coaxially arranged and spaced apart and configured to wind multiple electrode plates simultaneously, and the multiple winding mechanisms share the same inner winding needle and inner clamping needle.
- 12.** The winding device according to claim 11, wherein multiple piezoelectric assemblies in the multiple winding mechanisms are respectively configured to independently adjust the circumferences of multiple outer winding needles in the multiple winding mechanisms.
- 13.** The winding device according to claim 1, further comprising: an electric slip ring, configured to provide a lead for connecting the piezoelectric assembly to an external circuit, the lead comprising an input line and an output line; wherein: the input line is configured to connect to the external circuit, and the output line is configured to connect to a wire of the piezoelectric assembly; and the external circuit inputs a driving voltage to the piezoelectric assembly through the lead and the wire.
- 14.** The winding device according to claim 1, wherein the winding mechanism further comprises: a displacement monitoring device, configured to monitor a displacement of the outer winding needle to perform closed-loop control of the piezoelectric assembly.
- 15.** The winding device according to claim 14, wherein the displacement monitoring device



comprises a displacement sensing piece and a displacement sensor, wherein the displacement sensing piece is fixed to the outer winding needle, and the displacement sensor is configured to emit a signal to irradiate the displacement sensing piece and determine a displacement of the outer winding needle according to strength of a signal returned.

**16.** The winding device according to claim 1, further comprising: a misalignment detection device, configured to detect an actual angle value of a tab of an electrode plate to be wound, wherein a difference between the actual angle value and a standard angle value corresponding to the tab is used to determine a misalignment amount of the tab, enabling the winding mechanism to adjust the circumference of the outer winding needle according to the misalignment amount, and the actual angle value is an angle through which the winding mechanism rotates when the tab reaches the winding mechanism.

**17.** The winding device according to claim 1, further comprising: a thickness detection device, configured to detect a thickness of the electrode plate to be wound and the separator, enabling the winding mechanism to adjust the circumference of the outer winding needle according to the thickness.

**18.** A winding method for controlling the winding mechanism in the winding device according to claim 1 to wind an electrode plate to form an electrode assembly, the winding method comprising: obtaining a detection result of the electrode plate; determining adjustment information of an outer winding needle in the winding mechanism according to the detection result, the adjustment information comprising an adjustment amount and/or adjustment direction of a circumference of the outer winding needle; and determining a driving voltage of a piezoelectric assembly in the winding mechanism according to the adjustment information.

**19.** The winding method according to claim 18, wherein a correction amount for a tab in an M-th layer of the electrode assembly is:  $C_m = M \cdot \Delta C$ , wherein  $\Delta C$  is an adjustment amount of the circumference of the outer winding needle, and  $C_m$  is the correction amount.

**20.** The winding method according to claim 18, further comprising: obtaining a displacement of the outer winding needle; and adjusting the driving voltage according to a difference between the displacement and a target value until the displacement of the outer winding needle equals the target value.

---